"No alteration in the old gaol. Allowance, to debtors, 3d. felons, 2d. and convicts, 4d. a day. Gaoler's salary augmented to £120 in lieu of the tap. The sick are supplied with medicines from the infirmary.

"The corporation have spared no expense for the new gaol which Mr. Blackburn is employed in building: there will be a proper separation of the different classes and sexes; and with a view to security, health, reformation, and convenience, I apprehend, it will be one of the first borough gaols in the kingdom.

"1787. 22 Dec., Debtors 18. Felons, etc., 22."

[From *An Account of Lazarettos*, p. 206.]

LIVERPOOL BRIDEWELL

This prison was built in 1776, on an eminence adjoining the workhouse near the town. The men and women have separate rooms, courts, etc. The women have six rooms below, and the same number above: the men have four rooms below, and four above. These are twelve feet by ten, and eight feet nine inches high; are furnished with bedsteads, blankets, and coverlets; but are too close, having no window, only an aperture in the door about nine inches square, and another near the ceiling. They have a workroom, twenty feet by sixteen feet nine inches. Near this room in the men's court is a pump, to which the women are tied every week and receive discipline. In this court is also a bath, with a new and singular contrivance. At one end of it was a standard for a long pole, at the extremity of which was fastened a chair. In this all the females (not the males) at their entrance, after a few questions, were placed, with a flannel shift on, and underwent a thorough ducking, thrice repeated—a use of a bath, which I dare say the legislature never thought of, when in their late Act they ordered baths with a view to cleanliness and preserving the health of prisoners; not for the exercise of a wanton and dangerous kind of severity. But I was glad to find this use of the bath has been discontinued since my visit in 1779. The severe weekly discipline of the women in the men's court is still continued.

"No alteration. The keeper's apartments having no view into either of the courts, may be one reason that both sexes were locked up. All the men were in heavy irons, and seven

out of eight women were chained to the floors, and in bed at noon on Sunday, having had no fire for several days.[1] The next day, two being thus chained, at my desire, they were released and set to picking oakum.[2]"

[From *An Account of Lazarettos*, p. 206.]

[1] "All the bedding was on the floors; for the bedsteads were laid in the upper rooms, because some of the prisoners had made a sort of ladder with them to get through the floor above, in order to facilitate an escape. But bedsteads and bedding are necessary for the health of prisoners; and escapes would be prevented by confinement in separate cells. In some of the cells solid stone or brick might be worked into the walls, about eighteen inches from the floor, and cased with oak planks raised at the head, on which the bedding might be laid, as I have seen in some foreign prisons.

[2] "In Chester City gaol, Liverpool bridewell, and other prisons, I told the keepers that steady, lenient, and persuasive methods with prisoners are the best means to prevent them from breaking out; for their minds being uneasy, and their bodies harassed, they are often driven to desperate attempts, which sometimes will be successful: and I mentioned the good effects of such measures at Oxford Castle. Some of the keepers said, 'they now find, they can do more with their prisoners by lenient measures, than with a rough hand.'"